PHA Study Report – Propane storage and propane –air dilution system

Integrated steel works (illustrative example)

Worked example for the Process Safety Analysis Toolkit: HAZID · HAZOP · FMECA · Fault tree · Event tree · Bow tie

Item	Detail
Documents	HAZID HI-EX-PR-001 · HAZOP HZ-EX-PR-001 · FMECA FM-EX-PR-001
Study dates	2026-11-05 (HAZID) · 2026-11-09 to 2026-11-11 (HAZOP) · 2026-11-12 (FMECA)
Facilitator / scribe	A. Facilitator / B. Scribe (Istec)
Revision	A – worked example

Illustrative training example. The plant arrangement, tag numbers and failure data are representative of an LPG storage and propane–air installation at a steel works; they are not design data of any real plant and must not be used for decisions about one.

1 Purpose and how to use this example

This example shows one study carried through every tool of the Process Safety Analysis Toolkit: the HAZID screens the installation and picks the HAZOP nodes; the HAZOP finds the scenarios and the safeguards claimed; the FMECA looks at how the protective equipment fails; the fault trees quantify the protection layers; the event tree follows a release to its outcomes; the bow ties show the barriers to manage. Every file opens in its tool, and the numbers agree across them.

Key results: bullet overfill 1.9E-3 /yr (fault tree FT-PR-01, protection PFDavg 3.9E-3); flammable propane–air mixture 1.2E-2 /yr (FT-PR-02, protection PFDavg 1.8E-2); gas detection and ESD PFDavg 3.9E-2 (FT-PR-03); vapour cloud explosion or BLEVE 1.2E-5 /yr (ETA-PR-01); internal explosion of the mixing station 7.6E-5 /yr (BT-PR-02).

File (Examples / Propane Storage and Dilution PHA)	Open with	Content
Propane storage - HAZID_Register.xlsx	Excel	HAZID register – 20 hazards
Propane storage - HAZOP HZ-EX-PR-001.hazop.json	HAZOP Study Manager	3 nodes, 32 deviations, 17 recommendations
Propane storage - HAZOP_Study_Workbook.xlsx / .xlsm	Excel	The same HAZOP in the workbook
Propane storage - FMECA_Workbook.xlsx / .xlsm	Excel	FMECA – 3 systems, 16 failure modes
Propane storage - FT-PR-01 Bullet overfill.fta.json	Fault Tree & PFD Calculator	FT-PR-01 – Storage bullet overfilled during unloading
Propane storage - FT-PR-02 Flammable propane-air mixture.fta.json	Fault Tree & PFD Calculator	FT-PR-02 – Propane–air mixture enters the flammable range
Propane storage - FT-PR-03 Gas detection and ESD.fta.json	Fault Tree & PFD Calculator	FT-PR-03 – Propane release at the unloading bay not isolated
Propane storage - ETA-PR-01 Major propane release.eta.json	Event Tree Analysis	ETA-PR-01 – Major propane release at the unloading bay or tank farm
Propane storage - BT-PR-01 Loss of containment.bowtie.json	Bow Tie Analysis	BT-PR-01 – Loss of containment of propane at the unloading bay and storage
Propane storage - BT-PR-02 Propane-air ignition.bowtie.json	Bow Tie Analysis	BT-PR-02 – Ignition of a propane–air mixture inside the dilution system

2 Source study and how this example was developed

The starting point is a published HAZOP case study of a propane storage and propane dilution system at a steel works. It lists three nodes – 301 road tanker to propane storage, 302 supply of propane to consumer, 303 propane dilution system – but its worksheet covers node 301 only: twelve deviations and two recommendations (earthing jumpers for static electricity, and a diesel generator for back-up power). The site is replaced by a fictional integrated steel works; the source tag numbers are kept.

Node 301 is reproduced with the source entries marked 'source', then completed and corrected. Nodes 302 and 303 are developed from good practice for LPG vaporisation and propane–air plants. Pressures in kg/cm² are converted to barg. The design data, set points and failure data are illustrative.

2.1 Gaps filled and corrections

#	Gap or weakness in the source	What this example does	Where
1	Node 301 'Higher level – tank pressurisation': the consequence understates the hazard	Overfill sends liquid propane to the relief valves – a large two-phase release; quantified in a fault tree	N01-06, FT-PR-01, BT-PR-01 T1
2	The level transmitter that gives the alarm also gives the trip – not independent	Modelled as a common-cause event; recommendation for an independent high-high switch	FT-PR-01 BE-004, R-004
3	'Lower temperature – no issue'	Auto-refrigeration of propane to −42 °C can cause brittle fracture of carbon steel	N01-08, R-007, BT-PR-01 T5
4	No hose failure, tanker drive-away or vehicle impact	Added as deviations and bow-tie threats with an emergency release coupling and brake interlock	N01-09, N01-10, R-006
5	Fire case stops at 'fire and explosion hazard'	BLEVE added as an event-tree end state with sprinkler cooling as a heading	N01-07, ETA-PR-01 H5, R-009
6	Source remark 'PSV testing should be incorporated in the maintenance schedule' was not a recommendation	Made a recommendation with a test interval	N01-02, R-003
7	Gas detectors at unspecified height	Propane vapour is heavier than air: detectors at low level; detection coverage modelled in the ESD fault tree	FT-PR-03 BE-005, R-008
8	Nodes 302 and 303 have no worksheet	Developed: pumps, vaporisers, regulator; propane–air mixing with the flammable-mixture scenario as the key hazard	N02, N03, FT-PR-02, BT-PR-02

3 Scope and system description

Propane from the road-tanker connection at the unloading bay (node 301: unloading arm, vapour compressors C-01/C-02/C-03, liquid line via ROV-1 and inlet valves ROV-11/21/31 to the three storage bullets T-1/T-2/T-3), the liquid draw-off, pumps P-01/P-02, vaporisers VAP-01/VAP-02 and regulator PCV-01 to the 1.5 barg vapour header and the steel-works consumers (node 302), and the propane–air mixing station MX-01 with air blowers B-01/B-02, ratio control and surge tank ST-01 supplying propane–air to the reheat-furnace and ladle-preheater burners (node 303).

Design basis: Receive propane from 20 t road tankers (tanker design 20.6 barg) without overfilling or overpressuring the bullets (design 17.5 barg, design minimum temperature −45 °C, maximum fill 85 % of volume); vaporise propane and deliver vapour at 1.5 barg; blend it with air to a propane–air mixture of about 55 % propane (well above the upper flammable limit of 9.5 %) at 0.8 barg. Source pressures in kg/cm² are converted to barg. All values are illustrative.

Exclusions: Road tanker itself (owned by the supplier); burner internals and burner management at the users; fire-water pump house; electrical substation. Propane deliveries on public roads.

Node	Name	Design intent	Design / operating parameters
N01	Node 301 – Road tanker unloading to propane storage T-1/T-2/T-3	Transfer liquid propane from a 20 t road tanker into one storage bullet at a time by vapour compression, without overfilling, overpressure or release	Bullets T-1/T-2/T-3: 3 x 60 m3, design 17.5 barg, design min. temperature −45 °C, PSV-11/21/31 at 17.5 barg; tanker design 20.6 barg (source: 21 kg/cm2); compressor trip at 20.6 barg; maximum fill 85 % (LT-11/21/31 LAH 80 %, LAHH 85 % → closes ROV-11/21/31) Operating: Unloading 60–90 min per delivery, about 150 deliveries a year; storage 5–12 barg depending on ambient temperature
N02	Node 302 – Supply of propane to consumers (pumps, vaporisers, PCV-01)	Draw liquid propane from storage, vaporise it completely and deliver dry vapour at 1.5 barg to the users and the mixing station	Liquid lines 25 barg design; vaporisers 25 barg (liquid side), PSV-02 at 20 barg; vapour header 3.5 barg design; PSV-03 at 3.0 barg; TSL-01 low vapour outlet temperature trip at 10 °C; LSH-01 high liquid level in vaporiser trip Operating: Liquid 8–12 barg; vapour 1.4–1.6 barg, 20–40 °C; up to 1 200 kg/h propane
N03	Node 303 – Propane dilution system (propane–air mixing station)	Blend propane vapour with air to a propane–air mixture of 55 % propane (Wobbe index matched to natural gas, above the upper flammable limit) at 0.8 barg, and never let the mixture approach the flammable range	Mixer and surge tank ST-01 3.5 barg design, PSV-04 at 2.0 barg; explosion vent panel EP-01 on ST-01; flame arrester FA-01 on the propane–air header; PSLL-01 low propane pressure trip stops B-01/B-02 and closes XV-01/XV-02 Operating: Propane–air 0.8 barg, 50–60 % propane, 300–2 500 Nm3/h

3.1 Risk criteria

All studies use the toolkit's 5 x 5 risk matrix: risk = severity (1–5) x likelihood (1–5); Low < 5, Medium 5–9, High 10–19, Very High ≥ 20. Likelihood bands: 1 < 1E-4 /yr, 2 1E-4–1E-3, 3 1E-3–1E-2, 4 1E-2–0.1, 5 > 0.1 /yr. Event-tree and bow-tie targets: catastrophic outcomes ≤ 1E-4 /yr, major ≤ 1E-2 /yr.

3.2 Team and sessions

Name	Company / department	Role	Attendance
A. Facilitator	Istec	Facilitator	Days 1–3
B. Scribe	Istec	Scribe	Days 1–3
C. Process	Utilities	Process engineer	Days 1–3
D. Operator	Utilities	LPG plant operator	Days 1–3
E. Instrument	Maintenance	Instrument / control engineer	Days 1–3
F. Mechanical	Maintenance	Mechanical engineer	Days 1–2
G. Safety	HSE	HSE / process safety	Days 1–3
H. Furnace	Rolling mill	Furnace operations representative	Day 3
I. Supplier	LPG supplier	Tanker operations representative	Day 1

Date	Nodes	Notes
2026-11-09	N01	Node 301 (tanker to storage) – source worksheet reviewed, completed and corrected; overfill referred to FT-PR-01, releases to BT-PR-01 / ETA-PR-01.
2026-11-10	N02	Node 302 (supply to consumers) – pumps, vaporisers, regulator.
2026-11-11	N03	Node 303 (propane dilution) – flammable-mixture scenario referred to FT-PR-02 and BT-PR-02. Study closed; FMECA on 12 Nov.

4 HAZID register

Structured brainstorm with the HAZID guidewords; S x L on the toolkit's 5 x 5 risk matrix; every High / Very High item sent to a HAZOP node or a quantified study. The whole LPG installation: unloading bay, tank farm, pump and vaporiser area, mixing station and the propane–air header to the furnace building, including traffic, utilities, maintenance and emergency response.

ID	Area	Guideword	Hazard	Cause / threat	Consequence	Existing safeguards	S x L	Further study	Rec.
HZD-01	Unloading bay	Fire and explosion	Liquid propane release during unloading	Hose / arm failure, coupling error, drive-away	Flash fire, jet fire, VCE; BLEVE of the tanker	Hose inspection, gas detection, ESD, sprinklers	5 x 3 = 15 High	HAZOP N01-09, N01-10; FT-PR-03; ETA-PR-01; BT-PR-01 T2, T3	R-006, R-008
HZD-02	Tank farm	Fire and explosion	Bullet overfilled during unloading	Ullage not checked; level gauge reads low; trip shares the gauge	Liquid relief through PSV-11/21/31 – large release	LAH, LAHH trip on the same transmitter, procedure	5 x 4 = 20 Very High	HAZOP N01-06; FT-PR-01; BT-PR-01 T1	R-004, R-005
HZD-03	Tank farm	Fire and explosion	BLEVE of a bullet in a fire	Jet or pool fire impinging on the vapour space	Fireball, fragments up to several hundred metres	Relief valves, sprinklers, separation	5 x 2 = 10 High	HAZOP N01-07; ETA-PR-01 H5; BT-PR-01	R-009
HZD-04	Tank farm	Pressure	Bullet overpressure in hot weather	Vapour pressure about 16 barg at 50 °C	Relief valve lifts – propane vapour vented	Design 17.5 barg, PSV-11/21/31	3 x 3 = 9 Medium	HAZOP N01-04	R-003
HZD-05	Unloading bay / tank farm	Temperature (low)	Brittle fracture after auto-refrigeration	Rapid depressurisation or flashing liquid leak (−42 °C)	Sudden failure of a pressurised line or vessel	Low-temperature carbon steel (to be verified)	5 x 2 = 10 High	HAZOP N01-08; BT-PR-01 T5	R-007
HZD-06	Unloading bay	Static electricity	Static discharge during filling	High flow; unbonded flanges; tanker not earthed	Ignition of a small leak	Earthing of line, tanker and tanks	4 x 3 = 12 High	HAZOP N01-03	R-001
HZD-07	Unloading bay	Transport / vehicles	Vehicle impact on the arm or bullets	Other traffic during unloading; reversing tanker	Release; escalation	Kerbs only	5 x 2 = 10 High	HAZOP N01-01; BT-PR-01 T6	R-016
HZD-08	Unloading bay	Human factors	Cold burns when connecting / disconnecting	Liquid propane spray from couplings	Frostbite to hands and face	Gloves	3 x 3 = 9 Medium	BT-PR-01 consequence COLD	
HZD-09	Pump and vaporiser area	Fire and explosion	Pump seal leak	Dry running, wear	Liquid propane release and fire near the bullets	Single seals, gas detection	5 x 3 = 15 High	HAZOP N02-02, N02-08; BT-PR-01 T4	R-010
HZD-10	Pump and vaporiser area	Process upset	Liquid carry-over from the vaporisers	Bath heater failure, flow above capacity	Liquid in the vapour header – burner flare-ups	TSL-01 trip	4 x 3 = 12 High	HAZOP N02-04, N02-05	R-011
HZD-11	Vapour header	Pressure	Vapour header overpressure	PCV-01 fails open	Leaks at users' fuel trains	SSV-01, PSV-03	4 x 3 = 12 High	HAZOP N02-03	R-012
HZD-12	Mixing station	Fire and explosion	Propane–air mixture in the flammable range	Loss of propane while the blowers run; ratio controller fault	Internal explosion of ST-01 and the header	PSLL-01 trip, AT-01 (not independent), FA-01	5 x 4 = 20 Very High	HAZOP N03-01, N03-02; FT-PR-02; BT-PR-02 T1	R-013
HZD-13	Mixing station	Start-up / shutdown	Start-up with air in the system	Purge omitted; blowers started first	Explosion at the first light-off	Procedure OP-PR-020	5 x 3 = 15 High	HAZOP N03-06; BT-PR-02 T2	R-014
HZD-14	Furnace building	Fire and explosion	Flashback from the burners	Low header pressure; mixture near the flammable range	Deflagration in the header	FA-01, users' BMS	5 x 2 = 10 High	HAZOP N03-07; BT-PR-02 T3	R-015
HZD-15	Whole installation	Utilities	Power failure	Grid failure	Loss of supply; ESD and gas detection on UPS only	Fail-closed ROVs, UPS-1	3 x 3 = 9 Medium	HAZOP N01-12, N02-10, N03-09	R-002
HZD-16	Whole installation	Maintenance	Opening equipment with propane inside	Single-valve isolation, trapped liquid	Flash fire, cold burns	Permit-to-work	4 x 3 = 12 High	HAZOP N01-13	
HZD-17	Whole installation	Natural events	Lightning strike	Thunderstorms (summer)	Ignition at a relief valve outlet	Lightning protection, earthing	4 x 2 = 8 Medium	–	
HZD-18	Whole installation	Security	Unauthorised access / tampering	Open site perimeter at the bay	Valves opened, release	Fenced compound, locked valves	4 x 2 = 8 Medium	–	
HZD-19	Whole installation	Emergency response	Fire brigade response to an LPG fire	Inexperience with BLEVE risk	Fire fighters exposed to a BLEVE	Emergency plan	5 x 2 = 10 High	ETA-PR-01; BT-PR-01	R-017
HZD-20	Whole installation	Environment	Propane venting to atmosphere	Relief valve lifts, maintenance venting	VOC emission; odour complaints	Vent to a safe location	2 x 3 = 6 Medium	–	

5 HAZOP results

Node	Name	Deviations	Highest risk before	Highest risk after	Recommendations
N01	Node 301 – Road tanker unloading to propane storage T-1/T-2/T-3	13	20	15	R-001, R-002, R-003, R-004, R-005, R-006, R-007, R-008, R-009, R-016, R-017
N02	Node 302 – Supply of propane to consumers (pumps, vaporisers, PCV-01)	10	15	10	R-002, R-005, R-008, R-010, R-011, R-012
N03	Node 303 – Propane dilution system (propane–air mixing station)	9	20	20	R-002, R-008, R-013, R-014, R-015

5.1 HAZOP worksheets

N01 – Node 301 – Road tanker unloading to propane storage T-1/T-2/T-3

Ref	Deviation	Causes	Consequences / comments	Safeguards	Risk before	Risk after	Rec.
N01-01	Flow / NO No / less flow – compressor malfunction	• Compressor C-01/C-02/C-03 trip or malfunction (source) • Vapour return valve closed	Low or no filling rate into the storage tank (source); longer tanker stay at the bay increases the exposure time for drive-away and traffic impact Source deviation 'No / less flow – compressor malfunction'.	• C-01/C-02/C-03 – Standby vapour compressor available (source)	2 x 4 = 8	2 x 3 = 6	R-016
N01-02	Flow / NO No flow – ROV-1 stuck closed while the compressor runs	• ROV-1 stuck closed (source) • Tank inlet ROV-11/21/31 closed (wrong tank selected or trip)	No filling of the storage tank; pressure rises in the tanker as the compressor keeps pushing vapour (source) – tanker relief valve may lift at the bay Source safeguards: compressor trip at 21 kg/cm2 (20.6 barg), tanker designed for 21 kg/cm2, pressure gauge and tanker PSV. Source remark: include PSV testing in the maintenance schedule (R-003).	• C-01/C-02/C-03 – Compressor discharge high-pressure trip at 20.6 barg (source: 21 kg/cm2) • Tanker designed for 20.6 barg; bullets designed for 17.5 barg (source) [IPL] • PG-01 – Pressure gauges PG-01, PG-12, PG-13, PG-14 on the unloading header and bullets; tanker pressure gauge (source)	4 x 3 = 12	4 x 2 = 8	R-003
N01-03	Flow / MORE More flow – high pressure difference between tanker and tank	• More pressure difference in tanker and tank (source) • Compressor run at full speed on a near-empty tank	Static charge generated in the line during liquid filling (source); spark discharge at an unbonded flange can ignite a small leak Source recommendation no. 1 (earthing jumpers at every flange) is R-001.	• EBI-1 – Tanker, line and tanks earthed; earth bonding interlock EBI-1 prevents compressor start without a verified tanker earth • Ignition source control – Ex equipment in zoned areas, hot-work permits, vehicle control, no mobile phones at the bay	4 x 3 = 12	4 x 2 = 8	R-001
N01-04	Pressure / MORE Higher pressure in the bullet during unloading	• Tank inlet closed while the compressor delivers vapour to the tanker side • Hot weather – vapour pressure 16 barg at 50 °C • Liquid overfill – no vapour space left (see N01-06)	Bullet pressure towards the 17.5 barg relief setting; PSV-11/21/31 lift and vent propane vapour; flammable cloud at the tank farm	• PSV-11/21/31 – Bullet relief valves PSV-11/21/31 at 17.5 barg, fire-case sized, discharging vertically upwards (source: 'PSV provided') [IPL] • PG-01 – Pressure gauges PG-01, PG-12, PG-13, PG-14 on the unloading header and bullets; tanker pressure gauge (source) • C-01/C-02/C-03 – Compressor discharge high-pressure trip at 20.6 barg (source: 21 kg/cm2)	4 x 3 = 12	4 x 2 = 8	R-003
N01-05	Pressure / LESS Lower pressure	• Covered in less flow (source) • Vapour drawn off faster than the liquid vaporises in winter	No hazard to the bullets – propane vapour pressure stays above atmospheric down to −42 °C; slower unloading only Source entry 'covered in less flow'.	• C-01/C-02/C-03 – Standby vapour compressor available (source)	1 x 3 = 3	1 x 3 = 3	
N01-06	Level / MORE Higher level in storage tank T-1/T-2/T-3 (overfill)	• Transfer not stopped at high level (source) • Wrong ullage – delivery larger than the free volume • Level transmitter LT-11/21/31 reads low (drift, stuck float)	Source: tank pressurisation. Correctly: the bullet fills liquid-full; liquid propane reaches the relief valves – liquid relief and a large two-phase release at the tank farm; hydraulic overpressure of the liquid-full bullet as it warms The source credited only the LT closing the ROV, whose transmitter is also the gauge the operator uses – not independent. Quantified in fault tree FT-PR-01 (top 1.9E-3 /yr); overfill is threat T1 of bow tie BT-PR-01. Likelihood after safeguards from the calculated frequency 1.9E-3 /yr.	• LT-11/21/31 – High-high level trip LAHH (85 %) from LT-11/21/31 closes ROV-11/21/31 and stops the compressors (source: LT closes ROV) [IPL] • LT-11/21/31 – High level alarm LAH at 80 % with operator response (stop unloading) [IPL] • Tanker unloading procedure OP-PR-010 and checklist: ullage check before unloading, operator in attendance throughout • PSV-11/21/31 – Bullet relief valves PSV-11/21/31 at 17.5 barg, fire-case sized,	5 x 4 = 20	5 x 3 = 15	R-004, R-005

Ref	Deviation	Causes	Consequences / comments	Safeguards	Risk before	Risk after	Rec.
				discharging vertically upwards (source: 'PSV provided')			
N01-07	Temperature / MORE Higher temperature – external fire	• External fire (source) • Pool fire from a release at the unloading bay	Fire and explosion hazard; high pressure (source); flame impingement on the vapour space of a bullet or tanker weakens the shell – BLEVE with fireball and fragments Source safeguards: PRV-01, gauges, gas detectors GLD-1/2/3, water sprinklers for the tanks and the unloading station, PSV. BLEVE is an end state of event tree ETA-PR-01.	• PSV-11/21/31 – Bullet relief valves PSV-11/21/31 at 17.5 barg, fire-case sized, discharging vertically upwards (source: 'PSV provided') [IPL] • PRV-01 – Thermal relief valve PRV-01 on the unloading liquid line (source) • GLD-1/2/3 – Gas leak detectors GLD-1, GLD-2, GLD-3 at the unloading bay and tank farm with alarm (source) • Water sprinklers on the bullets and the tanker unloading station (source), 10 l/min/m2 • ESD-1 – Manual ESD push buttons at the unloading bay, tank farm and control room • Emergency response team and fire brigade; LPG emergency plan (cooling, evacuation radius)	5 x 2 = 10	5 x 1 = 5	R-009, R-017
N01-08	Temperature / LESS Lower temperature – auto-refrigeration	• Rapid depressurisation / venting of liquid propane (auto-refrigeration to −42 °C) • Liquid leak through a valve – flashing liquid chills the line	Source: 'no issue'. Correctly: carbon steel below its minimum design temperature becomes brittle; a pressurised bullet or line can fail by brittle fracture – sudden large release; cold burns to operators Corrected source entry. Brittle fracture is threat T5 of bow tie BT-PR-01.	• Bullets and liquid lines in low-temperature carbon steel (design min. −45 °C) [IPL] • Depressurisation procedure: no rapid venting of liquid-full equipment; vent only vapour to the flare stack	5 x 2 = 10	5 x 1 = 5	R-007
N01-09	Flow / AS WELL AS Release during transfer – hose / arm failure	• Unloading arm or hose failure (wear, kinking, wrong gasket) • Coupling not fully engaged	Liquid propane release at the unloading bay at up to 10 barg; large flammable cloud (heavier than air); jet fire if ignited; exposure of the tanker Not in the source worksheet. Threat T2 of bow tie BT-PR-01; isolation by fault tree FT-PR-03.	• Unloading arm / hose inspection and annual pressure test; leak test before each transfer • UCP-1 – Gas detection GLD-1/2/3 (1oo3) and manual ESD ESD-1 close ROV-1 and ROV-11/21/31 and stop C-01/C-02/C-03 (logic UCP-1) [IPL] • GLD-1/2/3 – Gas leak detectors GLD-1, GLD-2, GLD-3 at the unloading bay and tank farm with alarm (source) • Ignition source control – Ex equipment in zoned areas, hot-work permits, vehicle control, no mobile phones at the bay	5 x 3 = 15	5 x 2 = 10	R-008
N01-10	Flow / REVERSE Tanker drive-away while still connected	• Driver moves the tanker before disconnection • Brakes not applied / chocks missing	Arm or hose pulled apart – liquid release from both the tanker and the plant side; severe if the excess-flow valves do not close Not in the source worksheet. Threat T3 of bow tie BT-PR-01.	• Tanker brake interlock and wheel chocks; keys held by the unloading operator • ERC-1 – Emergency release coupling ERC-1 on the unloading arm with self-closing valves on both sides [IPL] • Tanker unloading procedure OP-PR-010 and checklist: ullage check before unloading, operator in attendance throughout	5 x 3 = 15	5 x 2 = 10	R-006
N01-11	Composition / AS WELL AS Impurity / concentration	• NA (source) • Water in the delivered propane • Butane-rich delivery (wrong grade)	Source: not applicable. Water can freeze in regulators and drains; butane raises the dew point – liquid in the vapour header (see N02) Source entries 'Concentration – NA' and 'Impurity – NA' reviewed: a delivery-quality check was added to the checklist.	• Tanker unloading procedure OP-PR-010 and checklist: ullage check before unloading, operator in attendance throughout	2 x 3 = 6	2 x 2 = 4	R-005
N01-12	Utilities / services / LOSS OF Utility failure – power	• Power failure (source) • Instrument air failure	No transfer of propane from tanker to storage tank; compressors C-01/C-02/C-03 stop (source). All ROVs and SVs close (source) – safe state, but the gas detection and ESD are lost if the UPS fails Source recommendation no. 2 (diesel generator for back-up power) is R-002.	• ROV-1 – All ROVs and solenoid valves fail closed on loss of power or air (source) [IPL] • UPS-1 – UPS for UCP-1 and the gas detection (30 min); ROVs fail closed	3 x 3 = 9	3 x 2 = 6	R-002
N01-13	Maintenance / INADEQUATE Maintenance – opening equipment that still contains propane	• Isolation by a single valve; liquid trapped between valves • Purge not complete before hot work	Propane release at the point of work; flash fire; cold burns	• Permit-to-work with isolation verification, N2 purge / gas-free test and fire watch • Ignition source control – Ex equipment in zoned areas, hot-work permits, vehicle control, no mobile phones at the bay	4 x 3 = 12	4 x 2 = 8	

N02 – Node 302 – Supply of propane to consumers (pumps, vaporisers, PCV-01)

Ref	Deviation	Causes	Consequences / comments	Safeguards	Risk before	Risk after	Rec.
N02-01	Flow / NO No liquid flow to the vaporisers	• Pump P-01/P-02 trip • Bullet outlet valve ROV-12/22/32 closed • Bullet empty / low level	Loss of propane vapour to the users and the mixing station; burners trip on low pressure; at the mixer, air may continue – see N03-01	• P-01/P-02 – Pump minimum-flow recycle and low-suction-pressure trip • PT-02 – Vapour header pressure alarms PAH / PAL on PT-02 with operator response • Low-low fuel pressure trips in the users' burner management systems [IPL]	3 x 4 = 12	3 x 3 = 9	
N02-02	Flow / LESS Pump cavitation / loss of suction	• Low liquid level in the bullet • Strainer blocked • High liquid temperature (summer) – low NPSH margin	Pump dry running – seal failure and liquid propane leak at the pump	• P-01/P-02 – Pump minimum-flow recycle and low-suction-pressure trip • P-01/P-02 – Double mechanical seals with seal-pot pressure alarm on P-01/P-02 • GLD-1/2/3 – Gas leak detectors GLD-1, GLD-2, GLD-3 at the unloading bay and tank farm with alarm (source)	4 x 3 = 12	4 x 2 = 8	R-010
N02-03	Pressure / MORE Higher pressure in the vapour header	• PCV-01 fails open • Regulator sensing line blocked • Vaporiser over-heating raises the pressure upstream	Vapour header (3.5 barg design) and users' fuel trains over-pressured – flange leaks, burner over-firing	• SSV-01 – Slam-shut valve SSV-01 upstream of PCV-01 closes at 2.5 barg (over-pressure shut-off) [IPL] • PSV-03 – Vapour header relief valve PSV-03 at 3.0 barg to a safe location [IPL] • PT-02 – Vapour header pressure alarms PAH / PAL on PT-02 with operator response	4 x 3 = 12	4 x 2 = 8	R-012
N02-04	Temperature / LESS Low vapour temperature – liquid carry-over from the vaporiser	• Vaporiser bath heater failure • Flow above the vaporiser capacity • Bath water level low	Liquid propane carried into the vapour header; liquid at regulators and burners – flare-ups, over-firing, cold embrittlement of carbon-steel piping	• VAP-01/VAP-02 – Vaporiser bath temperature control with duty / standby vaporisers • TSL-01 – Low vapour outlet temperature trip TSL-01 (10 °C) closes the vaporiser liquid inlet [IPL] • LSH-01 – High liquid level trip LSH-01 in the vaporiser shell closes the liquid inlet (liquid carry-over protection)	4 x 3 = 12	4 x 2 = 8	R-011
N02-05	Level / MORE High liquid level in the vaporiser shell	• Inlet control valve fails open • Vapour draw-off restricted	Liquid carry-over to the header (as N02-04)	• LSH-01 – High liquid level trip LSH-01 in the vaporiser shell closes the liquid inlet (liquid carry-over protection) [IPL] • TSL-01 – Low vapour outlet temperature trip TSL-01 (10 °C) closes the vaporiser liquid inlet	4 x 3 = 12	4 x 2 = 8	R-011
N02-06	Pressure / MORE Vaporiser overpressure – liquid side	• Liquid blocked in between closed valves and heated (thermal expansion) • Bath over-temperature	Rupture of the vaporiser tube bundle – propane into the water bath and its vent	• PSV-02 – Vaporiser relief valve PSV-02 at 20 barg [IPL] • VAP-01/VAP-02 – Vaporiser bath temperature control with duty / standby vaporisers	4 x 2 = 8	4 x 1 = 4	
N02-07	Flow / AS WELL AS Propane in the vaporiser hot-water circuit	• Tube leak in VAP-01/VAP-02	Propane carried to the hot-water tank vent – flammable atmosphere at the boiler house	• GLD-1/2/3 – Gas leak detectors GLD-1, GLD-2, GLD-3 at the unloading bay and tank farm with alarm (source)	4 x 2 = 8	4 x 2 = 8	
N02-08	Fire and explosion / REVIEW Leak from the liquid lines / pump seals	• Pump seal failure • Flange gasket failure • Corrosion under insulation at the liquid lines	Liquid propane release at the pump area; flash fire or jet fire; escalation to the bullets	• P-01/P-02 – Double mechanical seals with seal-pot pressure alarm on P-01/P-02 • GLD-1/2/3 – Gas leak detectors GLD-1, GLD-2, GLD-3 at the unloading bay and tank farm with alarm (source) • UCP-1 – Gas detection GLD-1/2/3 (1oo3) and manual ESD ESD-1 close ROV-1 and ROV-11/21/31 and stop C-01/C-02/C-03 (logic UCP-1) [IPL] • Separation distances to buildings, roads and the furnace area; bunded / kerbed impoundment sloped away from the bullets	5 x 3 = 15	5 x 2 = 10	R-010, R-008
N02-09	Composition / OTHER THAN Heavier hydrocarbons in the vapour (butane-rich propane)	• Off-spec delivery • Residue accumulation in the vaporiser	Re-condensation in the cold vapour header in winter; change in heating value at the users	• Tanker unloading procedure OP-PR-010 and checklist: ullage check before unloading, operator in attendance throughout	2 x 3 = 6	2 x 2 = 4	R-005
N02-10	Utilities / services / LOSS OF Loss of power to the vaporisers and pumps	• Power failure • Vaporiser heater trip	Loss of supply to the users (controlled trip); on restart, liquid carry-over if the bath is cold	• TSL-01 – Low vapour outlet temperature trip TSL-01 (10 °C) closes the vaporiser liquid inlet [IPL] • Low-low fuel pressure trips in the users'	3 x 3 = 9	3 x 2 = 6	R-002

Ref	Deviation	Causes	Consequences / comments	Safeguards	Risk before	Risk after	Rec.
				burner management systems			

N03 – Node 303 – Propane dilution system (propane–air mixing station)

Ref	Deviation	Causes	Consequences / comments	Safeguards	Risk before	Risk after	Rec.
N03-01	Flow / LESS Less / no propane to the mixer while air continues – mixture moves into the flammable range	• Loss of propane vapour supply (vaporiser trip, PCV-01 closes, header low pressure) • XV-01 closes spuriously • FFIC-01 propane flow transmitter fails high	Propane fraction falls from 55 % towards the flammable range (below 9.5 % in air) – explosive mixture in the mixer, surge tank ST-01 and the header to the burners; ignition at a burner flashes back – internal explosion of ST-01 and the header Key scenario of the dilution system. Quantified in fault tree FT-PR-02 (top 1.2E-2 /yr); threat T1 of bow tie BT-PR-02. Likelihood after safeguards from the calculated frequency 1.2E-2 /yr.	• PSLL-01 – Low propane pressure trip PSLL-01: stops B-01/B-02 and closes XV-01 / XV-02 (mixture trip) [IPL] • FFIC-01 – Propane / air ratio controller FFIC-01 with cross-limiting (air follows propane) • AT-01 – Calorimeter / Wobbe analyser AT-01 with low-heating-value trip (independent of FFIC-01) [IPL] • FA-01 – In-line flame arrester FA-01 on the propane–air header to the users	5 x 4 = 20	5 x 4 = 20	R-013
N03-02	Flow / MORE More air than set (ratio controller failure)	• FFIC-01 fails / air flow transmitter fails low • Blower B-01/B-02 speed control fault	Lower heating value at the burners (flame instability); if severe, mixture approaches the flammable range (as N03-01)	• AT-01 – Calorimeter / Wobbe analyser AT-01 with low-heating-value trip (independent of FFIC-01) [IPL] • FFIC-01 – Propane / air ratio controller FFIC-01 with cross-limiting (air follows propane)	5 x 3 = 15	5 x 2 = 10	R-013
N03-03	Flow / REVERSE Propane back-flow into the air blowers	• Blower trip with propane pressure higher than the air side • NRV-01 passing	Propane in the blower suction – flammable mixture at the blower motor (not Ex-rated); blower fire	• NRV-01 – Non-return valve NRV-01 on the air line to MX-01 (prevents propane back-flow into the blowers) • PSLL-01 – Low propane pressure trip PSLL-01: stops B-01/B-02 and closes XV-01 / XV-02 (mixture trip)	4 x 3 = 12	4 x 2 = 8	
N03-04	Pressure / MORE Higher pressure in the mixer / surge tank	• Users' fuel valves close quickly (load rejection) • Propane regulator PCV-01 fails open (N02-03)	Surge tank ST-01 (3.5 barg design) over-pressured – flange leak of propane–air	• PSV-04 – Surge tank relief valve PSV-04 at 2.0 barg [IPL] • SSV-01 – Slam-shut valve SSV-01 upstream of PCV-01 closes at 2.5 barg (over-pressure shut-off)	3 x 3 = 9	3 x 2 = 6	
N03-05	Composition / OTHER THAN Mixture outside specification at the burners	• AT-01 drift • Butane-rich vapour (N02-09)	Flame instability or over-firing at the reheat-furnace and ladle-preheater burners; flame-out with fuel flow (users' BMS)	• AT-01 – Calorimeter / Wobbe analyser AT-01 with low-heating-value trip (independent of FFIC-01) • Low-low fuel pressure trips in the users' burner management systems [IPL]	3 x 3 = 9	3 x 2 = 6	R-013
N03-06	Start-up / REVIEW Start-up with air in the mixer, surge tank or header	• Purge not done or incomplete after maintenance • Blowers started before propane is established	Flammable propane–air mixture in ST-01 and the header during start-up; ignition at the first burner light-off – internal explosion Threat T2 of bow tie BT-PR-02.	• Start-up procedure OP-PR-020: N2 purge of mixer and surge tank, propane established before air, mixture verified by AT-01 before supply • AT-01 – Calorimeter / Wobbe analyser AT-01 with low-heating-value trip (independent of FFIC-01) • FA-01 – In-line flame arrester FA-01 on the propane–air header to the users [IPL]	5 x 3 = 15	5 x 2 = 10	R-014
N03-07	Flow / REVERSE Flashback from the burners into the propane–air header	• Header pressure lower than furnace pressure • Burner flashback when the mixture is near the flammable range	Flame propagation into the header and surge tank – deflagration Threat T3 of bow tie BT-PR-02.	• FA-01 – In-line flame arrester FA-01 on the propane–air header to the users [IPL] • Low-low fuel pressure trips in the users' burner management systems	5 x 2 = 10	5 x 1 = 5	R-015
N03-08	Fire and explosion / REVIEW Leak of propane–air from the mixer or header	• Flange or expansion-joint failure • Corrosion of the header	Flammable release near the furnace building (many ignition sources); flash fire	• GLD-1/2/3 – Gas leak detectors GLD-1, GLD-2, GLD-3 at the unloading bay and tank farm with alarm (source) • UCP-1 – Gas detection GLD-1/2/3 (1oo3) and manual ESD ESD-1 close ROV-1 and ROV-11/21/31 and stop C-01/C-02/C-03 (logic UCP-1) • Ignition source control – Ex equipment in zoned areas, hot-work permits, vehicle control, no mobile phones at the bay	4 x 3 = 12	4 x 2 = 8	R-008

Ref	Deviation	Causes	Consequences / comments	Safeguards	Risk before	Risk after	Rec.
N03-09	Utilities / services / LOSS OF Power failure at the mixing station	• Power failure • UPS failure	Blowers stop; propane continues at full pressure to the users (heating value too high) unless XV-01 closes; on restart, sequence must re-establish propane before air	• ROV-1 – All ROVs and solenoid valves fail closed on loss of power or air (source) [IPL] • Start-up procedure OP-PR-020: N2 purge of mixer and surge tank, propane established before air, mixture verified by AT-01 before supply	3 x 3 = 9	3 x 2 = 6	R-002, R-014

6 FMECA results

Systems S01–S03 correspond one-to-one with the HAZOP nodes. RPN = S x O x D (1–10 scales); action priority from the AIAG-VDA table in the workbook.

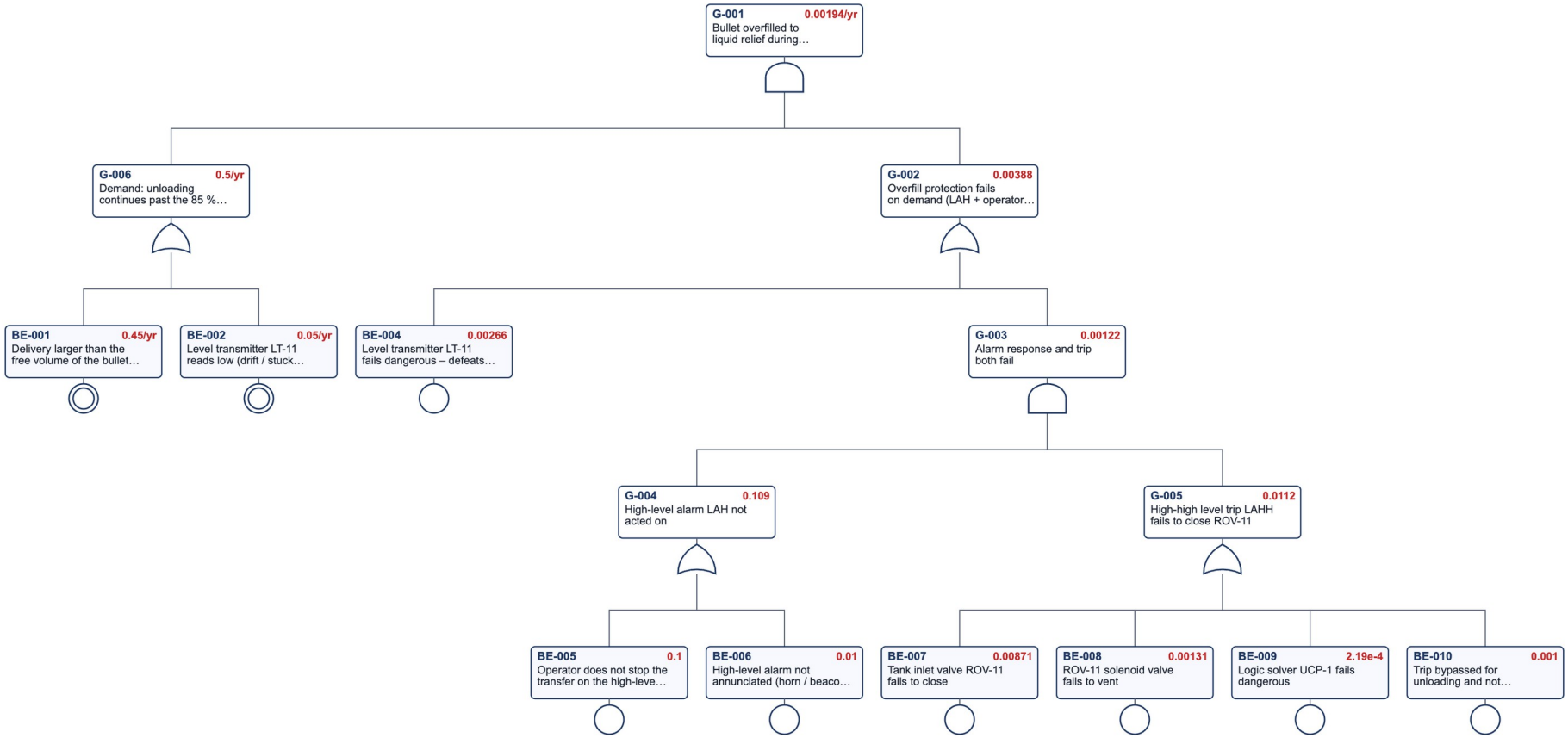
Ref	Tag	Component	Failure mode	End effect	S·O·D	RPN	Recommended action	After	HAZOP
S01-01	LT-11	Sensing element	LOO – Low reading / drift low	Liquid propane to the relief valves – large release (BT-PR-01 T1)	10·4·6	240	Independent high-high level switch on each bullet; six-monthly trip test (R-004)	10·2·3 = 60	HAZOP N01-06 Fault tree FT-PR-01 event BE-004
S01-02	ROV-11	Actuator	FTC – Fail to close on demand	Overfill (FT-PR-01) or release not isolated (FT-PR-03)	9·3·6	162	–	–	HAZOP N01-06 Fault tree FT-PR-01 event BE-007
S01-03	ERC-1	Hoses	ELP – External leakage – process medium	Flash fire / jet fire (BT-PR-01 T3)	10·3·7	210	Fit ERC-1 and a brake interlock (R-006)	10·2·5 = 100	HAZOP N01-10
S01-04	PSV-11	Nozzle and disc	FTO – Fail to open on demand	BLEVE (ETA-PR-01)	10·2·7	140	Two-yearly bench test in the inspection schedule (R-003)	10·2·4 = 80	HAZOP N01-07
S01-05	GLD-1	Sensor	FTF – Fail to function on demand	Larger flammable cloud (FT-PR-03)	8·4·4	128	Relocate at low level (R-008)	8·3·4 = 96	HAZOP N01-09 Fault tree FT-PR-03 event BE-001
S01-06	C-01	Valves	BRD – Breakdown	Longer tanker stay – exposure	4·5·2	40	–	–	HAZOP N01-01
S02-01	P-01	Mechanical seal	ELP – External leakage – process medium	Flash fire / jet fire (BT-PR-01 T4)	9·4·4	144	Double mechanical seals with seal-pot alarm (R-010)	9·2·3 = 54	HAZOP N02-02
S02-02	VAP-01	Tubes	PDE – Reduced heat transfer	Flare-ups at burners; cold embrittlement	8·4·3	96	Independent LSH-01 high-level trip (R-011)	8·3·3 = 72	HAZOP N02-04
S02-03	TSL-01	Sensing element	FTF – Fail to function on demand	As VAP-01	8·3·6	144	Six-monthly test with LSH-01 (R-011)	8·3·4 = 96	HAZOP N02-04
S02-04	PCV-01	Trim (plug / seat)	FTC – Fail to close on demand	Flange leaks, burner over-firing	7·4·3	84	Confirm set-point staggering (R-012)	7·3·3 = 63	HAZOP N02-03 Also initiator BE-001 of FT-PR-02 when it fails closed
S03-01	PSLL-01	Sensing element	FTF – Fail to function on demand	Flammable mixture in ST-01 (FT-PR-02)	10·3·6	180	Second pressure switch (1oo2) (R-013)	10·2·4 = 80	HAZOP N03-01 Fault tree FT-PR-02 event BE-004
S03-02	AT-01	Sensor	FTF – Fail to function on demand	Internal explosion (BT-PR-02)	10·4·5	200	Independent AT-01 trip path (R-013)	10·3·4 = 120	HAZOP N03-01 Fault tree FT-PR-02 event BE-008
S03-03	XV-02	Actuator	FTC – Fail to close on demand	Flammable mixture (FT-PR-02)	9·3·6	162	–	–	HAZOP N03-01 Fault tree FT-PR-02 event BE-006
S03-04	FFIC-01	Transmitter electronics	HIO – High reading / drift high	Mixture approaches the flammable range	9·4·5	180	–	–	HAZOP N03-02 Initiator BE-003 of FT-PR-02
S03-05	FA-01	Pipe	PLU – Plugged / choked	Flashback not stopped (BT-PR-02 T3)	8·4·6	192	Six-monthly inspection (R-015)	8·3·4 = 96	HAZOP N03-07
S03-06	B-01	Impeller / rotor	UST – Spurious stop	Over-firing at burners	5·4·2	40	–	–	HAZOP N03-09

7 Fault tree analysis

Every fault tree was calculated by the Fault Tree & PFD Calculator (exact BDD, time-averaged PFDavg over the proof-test cycle). Basic-event values come from the data library where an item fits: 'checked' items were compared with the reference table named; 'typical' items must be verified against the edition used.

7.1 FT-PR-01 – Storage bullet overfilled during unloading

Top event: a bullet T-1/T-2/T-3 is filled liquid-full during tanker unloading, so liquid propane reaches the relief valves PSV-11/21/31. Demand = unloading continues past the 85 % fill limit (gate G-006); protection = high-level alarm LAH with operator response and the high-high trip LAHH closing ROV-11/21/31 (gate G-002). As in the source design, both use the same level transmitter LT-11/21/31 – event BE-004 is a common cause (R-004). Gate G-002 is the overfill barrier of bow tie BT-PR-01 (threat T1). HAZOP N01-06; FMECA S01.



FT-PR-01 as drawn by the Fault Tree & PFD Calculator (red: time-averaged values).

Top-event frequency 1.9E-3 /yr. Gate values: G-001 1.9E-3; G-002 3.9E-3; G-003 1.2E-3; G-004 1.1E-1; G-005 1.1E-2; G-006 5.0E-1.

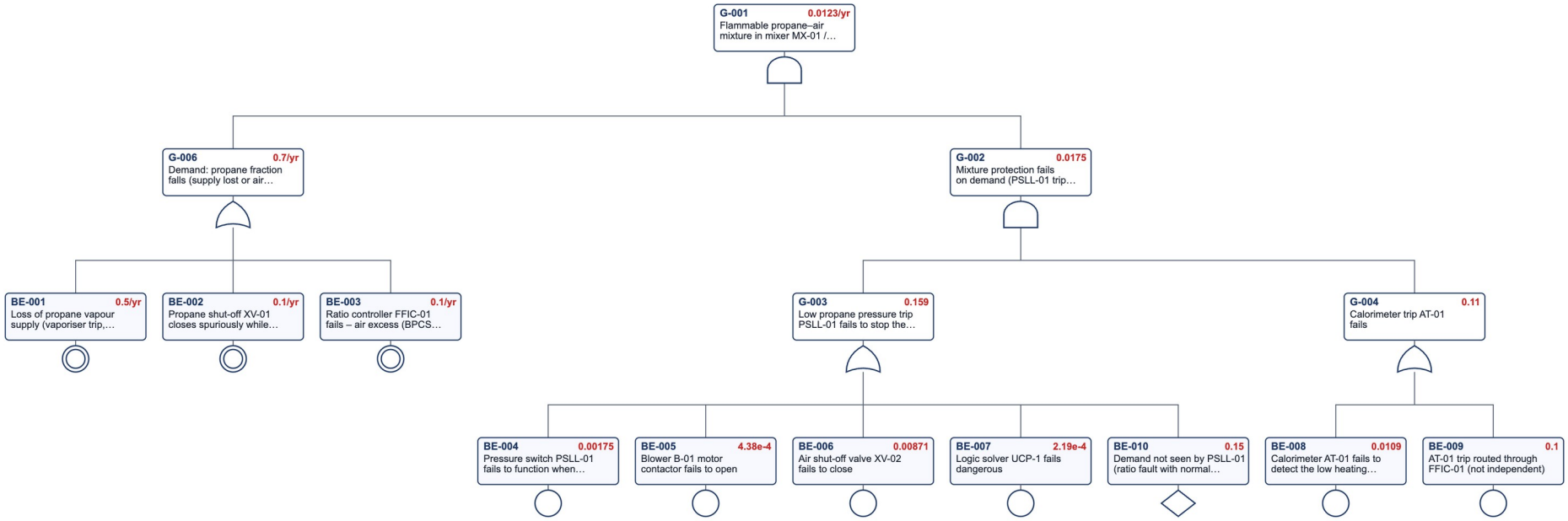
Event	Description	Fussell-Vesely	RAW
BE-001	Delivery larger than the free volume of the bullet – ullage not checked	0.900	–
BE-004	Level transmitter LT-11 fails dangerous – defeats both the alarm and the trip	0.685	2.6E2
BE-005	Operator does not stop the transfer on the high-level alarm	0.286	3.6E0
BE-007	Tank inlet valve ROV-11 fails to close	0.243	2.9E1
BE-002	Level transmitter LT-11 reads low (drift / stuck float) – operator unaware	0.100	–
BE-008	ROV-11 solenoid valve fails to vent	0.036	2.9E1

Event	Library item	Value	Status
BE-004	Level transmitter, radar – λDU	6.0E-7 /h	typical – verify
BE-005	Operator response to an independent alarm, ≥ 10 min, simple documented action, clear indication	1.0E-1	checked – CCPS LOPA (2001), Table 6.5; CCPS Guidelines for Hazard Evaluation Procedures, 3rd ed., Table 7.4; CCPS Guidelines for Initiating Events and IPLs in LOPA (2015), Data Table 5.46
BE-006	Alarm horn / beacon fails on demand	1.0E-2	typical – verify
BE-007	Shutdown valve (ball / gate) with actuator – λDU	2.0E-6 /h	typical – verify
BE-008	Solenoid / pilot valve on an actuator – λDU	3.0E-7 /h	typical – verify
BE-009	Safety PLC, per function incl. I/O (certified) – λDU	5.0E-8 /h	typical – verify

The protection PFDavg of 3.9E-3 is dominated by the shared level transmitter (BE-004). With an independent high-high switch (R-004) the alarm and the trip become two independent layers.

7.2 FT-PR-02 – Propane–air mixture enters the flammable range

Top event: the propane fraction in mixer MX-01 / surge tank ST-01 falls into the flammable range because propane is lost or air is over-supplied while blowers B-01/B-02 keep running, and both mixture protections fail. Protection (gate G-002) = low propane pressure trip PSLL-01 (stops the blowers, closes XV-01 / XV-02) AND the calorimeter trip AT-01. PSLL-01 cannot see a ratio-controller fault (BE-010). Gate G-002 is the mixture barrier of bow tie BT-PR-02 (threat T1). HAZOP N03-01; FMECA S03.



FT-PR-02 as drawn by the Fault Tree & PFD Calculator (red: time-averaged values).

Top-event frequency 1.2E-2 /yr. Gate values: G-001 1.2E-2; G-002 1.8E-2; G-003 1.6E-1; G-004 1.1E-1; G-006 7.0E-1.

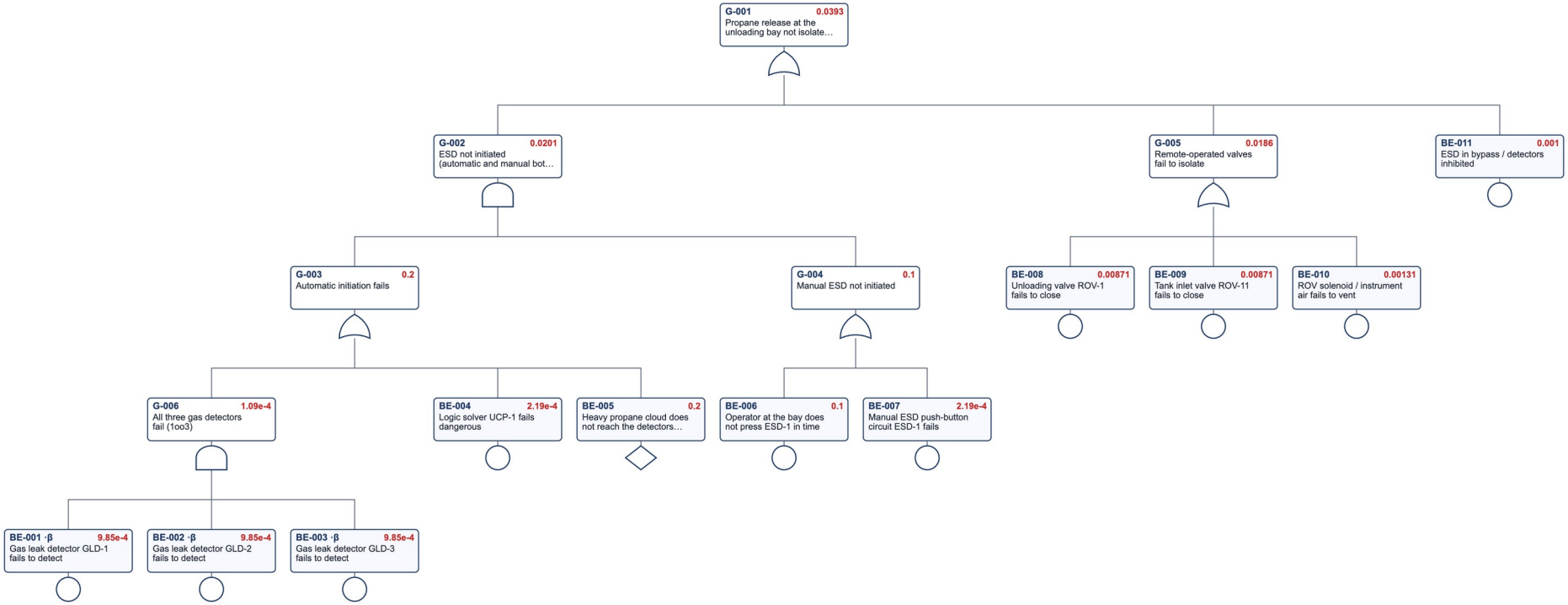
Event	Description	Fussell-Vesely	RAW
BE-010	Demand not seen by PSLL-01 (ratio fault with normal propane pressure)	0.930	6.3E0
BE-009	AT-01 trip routed through FFIC-01 (not independent)	0.901	9.1E0
BE-001	Loss of propane vapour supply (vaporiser trip, PCV-01 closes, header pressure low)	0.714	–
BE-002	Propane shut-off XV-01 closes spuriously while the blowers run	0.143	–
BE-003	Ratio controller FFIC-01 fails – air excess (BPCS loop failure)	0.143	–
BE-008	Calorimeter AT-01 fails to detect the low heating value	0.089	9.1E0

Event	Library item	Value	Status
BE-002	Spurious trip of a SIF (process upset on restart)	1.0E-1 /yr	typical – verify
BE-003	BPCS instrument loop failure	1.0E-1 /yr	checked – CCPS LOPA (2001), Table 5.1; CCPS Guidelines for Initiating Events and IPLs in LOPA (2015), Data Table 4.1
BE-004	Electric pressure switch – fails to function when required	4.0E-7 /h	checked – CCPS Guidelines for Process Equipment Reliability Data (1989), taxonomy 2.1.4.1.3 – mean
BE-005	Motor starter / contactor (trip a pump) – λDU	1.0E-7 /h	typical – verify
BE-006	Shutdown valve (ball / gate) with actuator – λDU	2.0E-6 /h	typical – verify
BE-007	Safety PLC, per function incl. I/O (certified) – λDU	5.0E-8 /h	typical – verify
BE-008	Process analyser (O2, H2, H2S) used in a SIF – λDU	5.0E-6 /h	typical – verify

The calorimeter trip routed through the ratio controller (BE-009) and the blind spot of PSLL-01 for ratio faults (BE-010) dominate; R-013 addresses both.

7.3 FT-PR-03 – Propane release at the unloading bay not isolated

Top event (gate G-001): a propane release at the unloading bay or tank farm is not isolated – neither gas detection GLD-1/2/3 (1oo3) through logic UCP-1 nor the operator's manual ESD-1 initiates, or ROV-1 / ROV-11 fail to close. PFDavg of G-001 is heading H2 of event tree ETA-PR-01 and the ESD barrier of bow tie BT-PR-01. HAZOP N01-09, N02-08; FMECA S01.



FT-PR-03 as drawn by the Fault Tree & PFD Calculator (red: time-averaged values).

Top-event PFDavg 3.9E-2. Gate values: G-001 3.9E-2; G-002 2.0E-2; G-003 2.0E-1; G-004 1.0E-1; G-005 1.9E-2; G-006 1.1E-4.

Event	Description	Fussell-Vesely	RAW
BE-005	Heavy propane cloud does not reach the detectors (mounted too high)	0.500	3.0E0
BE-006	Operator at the bay does not press ESD-1 in time	0.500	5.5E0
BE-008	Unloading valve ROV-1 fails to close	0.215	2.5E1
BE-009	Tank inlet valve ROV-11 fails to close	0.215	2.5E1
BE-010	ROV solenoid / instrument air fails to vent	0.032	2.5E1
BE-011	ESD in bypass / detectors inhibited	0.024	2.5E1

Event	Library item	Value	Status
BE-001	Point gas detector, catalytic – λDU	1.0E-6 /h	typical – verify
BE-002	Point gas detector, catalytic – λDU	1.0E-6 /h	typical – verify
BE-003	Point gas detector, catalytic – λDU	1.0E-6 /h	typical – verify

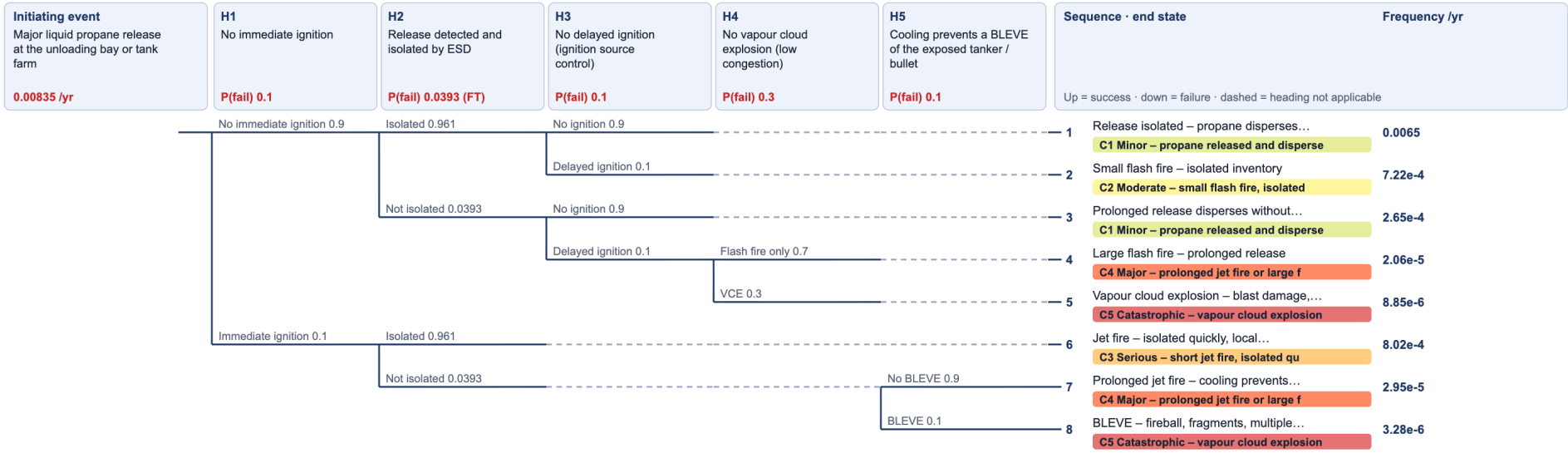
Event	Library item	Value	Status
BE-004	Safety PLC, per function incl. I/O (certified) – λDU	5.0E-8 /h	typical – verify
BE-006	Operator response to an independent alarm, ≥ 10 min, simple documented action, clear indication	1.0E-1	checked – CCPS LOPA (2001), Table 6.5; CCPS Guidelines for Hazard Evaluation Procedures, 3rd ed., Table 7.4; CCPS Guidelines for Initiating Events and IPLs in LOPA (2015), Data Table 5.46
BE-007	Hard-wired relay logic, per function – λDU	5.0E-8 /h	typical – verify
BE-008	Shutdown valve (ball / gate) with actuator – λDU	2.0E-6 /h	typical – verify
BE-009	Shutdown valve (ball / gate) with actuator – λDU	2.0E-6 /h	typical – verify
BE-010	Solenoid / pilot valve on an actuator – λDU	3.0E-7 /h	typical – verify

The heavy-gas detection coverage (BE-005) and the operator's manual ESD dominate the PFDavg of 3.9E-2.

8 Event tree analysis

8.1 ETA-PR-01 – Major propane release at the unloading bay or tank farm

Initiating event = top event of bow tie BT-PR-01, frequency 8.3E-3 /yr. H2 is linked to fault tree FT-PR-03 (gas detection & ESD). End-state frequencies are reproduced by the bow-tie consequences JET, BLEVE, FF and VCE. HAZOP N01-07, N01-09, N02-08. Illustrative probabilities.



ETA-PR-01 as drawn by Event Tree Analysis.

Heading	Success / failure	P(failure)	Source
H1 No immediate ignition	No immediate ignition / Immediate ignition	1.0E-1	Large liquid LPG release, ignition at the source – illustrative; = BT-PR-01 'BLEVE' condition
H2 Release detected and isolated by ESD	Isolated / Not isolated	3.9E-2	PFDavg from fault tree FT-PR-03 gate G-001 = BT-PR-01 ESD barrier
H3 No delayed ignition (ignition source control)	No ignition / Delayed ignition	1.0E-1	Library ipl-ign-good (CCPS HEP Table 7.4) = BT-PR-01 barrier 'Ignition source control'

Heading	Success / failure	P(failure)	Source
H4 No vapour cloud explosion (low congestion)	Flash fire only / VCE	3.0E-1	Fraction of delayed ignitions in congested areas (compressor house, pipe racks) – illustrative
H5 Cooling prevents a BLEVE of the exposed tanker / bullet	No BLEVE / BLEVE	1.0E-1	= BT-PR-01 barrier 'Sprinkler / deluge cooling' (R-009)

End state	Category	Frequency /yr
Release isolated – propane disperses without ignition	C1 – Minor – propane released and dispersed	6.5E-3
Small flash fire – isolated inventory	C2 – Moderate – small flash fire, isolated inventory	7.2E-4
Prolonged release disperses without ignition – area evacuated	C1 – Minor – propane released and dispersed	2.7E-4
Large flash fire – prolonged release	C4 – Major – prolonged jet fire or large flash fire	2.1E-5
Vapour cloud explosion – blast damage, multiple fatalities	C5 – Catastrophic – vapour cloud explosion or BLEVE, multiple fatalities	8.8E-6
Jet fire – isolated quickly, local damage	C3 – Serious – short jet fire, isolated quickly	8.0E-4
Prolonged jet fire – cooling prevents BLEVE	C4 – Major – prolonged jet fire or large flash fire	2.9E-5
BLEVE – fireball, fragments, multiple fatalities	C5 – Catastrophic – vapour cloud explosion or BLEVE, multiple fatalities	3.3E-6

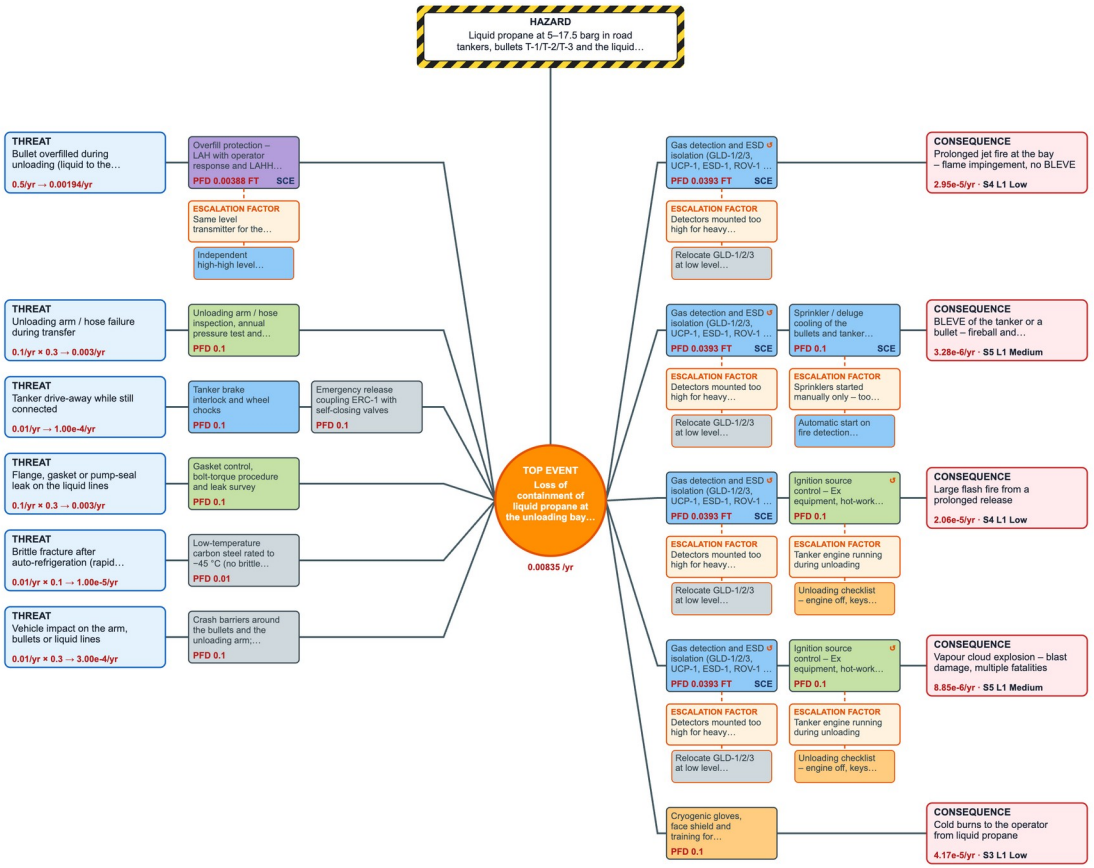
Category	Frequency /yr	Target /yr	Meets target?
C1 Minor – propane released and dispersed	6.8E-3	–	Yes
C2 Moderate – small flash fire, isolated inventory	7.2E-4	1	Yes
C3 Serious – short jet fire, isolated quickly	8.0E-4	0.1	Yes
C4 Major – prolonged jet fire or large flash fire	5.0E-5	0.01	Yes
C5 Catastrophic – vapour cloud explosion or BLEVE, multiple fatalities	1.2E-5	0.0001	Yes

The vapour cloud explosion and BLEVE frequency of 1.2E-5 /yr meets the 1E-4 /yr target; the major-outcome frequency 5.0E-5 /yr meets the 1E-2 /yr target.

9 Bow tie analysis

9.1 BT-PR-01 – Loss of containment of propane at the unloading bay and storage

Threat T1 frequency = demand gate G-006 of fault tree FT-PR-01 with the overfill barrier = FT-PR-01 gate G-002, so its contribution equals the FT-PR-01 top event. The ESD barrier = FT-PR-03 gate G-001. The top-event frequency is the initiating frequency of event tree ETA-PR-01; consequences JET, BLEVE, FF and VCE reproduce its end states. HAZOP N01, N02; FMECA S01, S02. Illustrative data.



BT-PR-01 as drawn by Bow Tie Analysis.

Hazard: Liquid propane at 5–17.5 barg in road tankers, bullets T-1/T-2/T-3 and the liquid lines (extremely flammable, heavier-than-air vapour). Top event: Loss of containment of liquid propane at the unloading bay or tank farm – frequency 8.3E-3 /yr.

Threat	Frequency /yr	Condition	Barriers	Contribution /yr
Bullet overfilled during unloading (liquid to the relief valves)	5.0E-1	1	Overfill protection – LAH with operator response and LAHH trip closing ROV-11/21/31	1.9E-3
Unloading arm / hose failure during transfer	1.0E-1	0.3	Unloading arm / hose inspection, annual pressure test and pre-transfer leak test	3.0E-3
Tanker drive-away while still connected	1.0E-2	1	Tanker brake interlock and wheel chocks Emergency release coupling ERC-1 with self-closing valves	1.0E-4
Flange, gasket or pump-seal leak on the liquid lines	1.0E-1	0.3	Gasket control, bolt-torque procedure and leak survey	3.0E-3
Brittle fracture after auto-refrigeration (rapid depressurisation)	1.0E-2	0.1	Low-temperature carbon steel rated to −45 °C (no brittle fracture on auto-refrigeration)	1.0E-5
Vehicle impact on the arm, bullets or liquid lines	1.0E-2	0.3	Crash barriers around the bullets and the unloading arm; vehicle-movement plan	3.0E-4

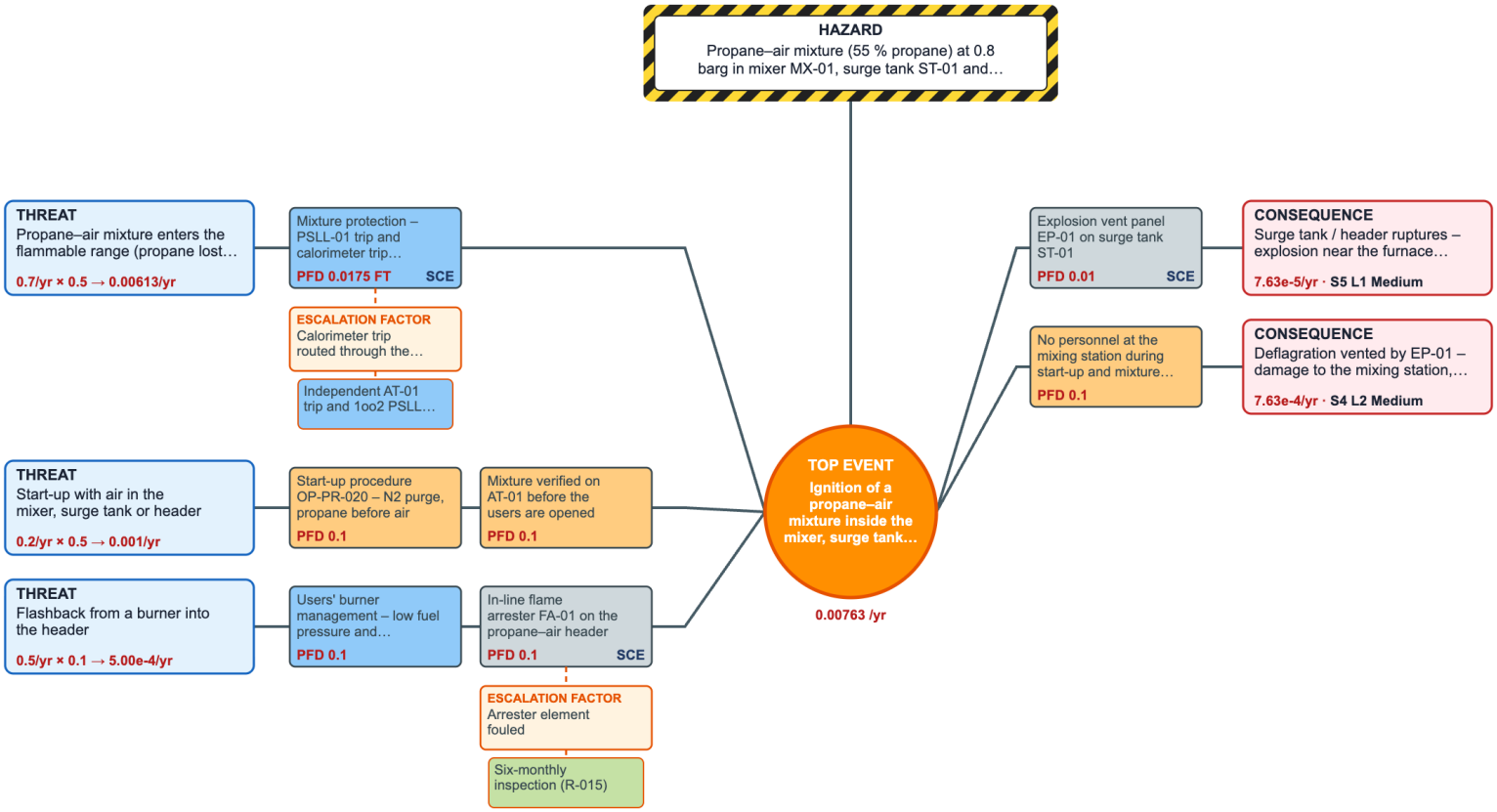
Barrier	Type	PFD	Performance standard	Verification	Critical
Overfill protection – LAH with operator response and LAHH trip closing ROV-11/21/31	Active human-hardware	3.9E-3	Unloading stopped before 85 % fill	Six-monthly trip test (R-004)	Yes
Unloading arm / hose inspection, annual pressure test and pre-transfer leak test	Continuous / procedural	1.0E-1	No hose fails in service	Inspection records	
Tanker brake interlock and wheel chocks	Active hardware	1.0E-1	Tanker cannot move while connected	Monthly function check	
Emergency release coupling ERC-1 with self-closing valves	Passive hardware	1.0E-1	Arm separates with both sides closed	Annual inspection	
Gasket control, bolt-torque procedure and leak survey	Continuous / procedural	1.0E-1	Joints made to procedure	Annual leak survey	
Low-temperature carbon steel rated to −45 °C (no brittle fracture on auto-refrigeration)	Passive hardware	1.0E-2	Material suitable for −45 °C	Material certificates; R-007 verification	
Crash barriers around the bullets and the unloading arm; vehicle-movement plan	Passive hardware	1.0E-1	No vehicle can strike the equipment	Annual inspection	
Gas detection and ESD isolation (GLD-1/2/3, UCP-1, ESD-1, ROV-1 / ROV-11)	Active hardware	3.9E-2	Release detected and isolated within 1 minute	Quarterly detector bump tests; annual ROV full-stroke tests	Yes
Ignition source control – Ex equipment, hot-work permits, vehicle control	Continuous / procedural	1.0E-1	No ignition source in the zoned area	Ex inspection; PTW audits	
Sprinkler / deluge cooling of the bullets and tanker prevents a BLEVE	Active hardware	1.0E-1	10 l/min/m2 on exposed shells within 2 minutes	Annual flow test (R-009)	Yes
Cryogenic gloves, face shield and training for connecting / disconnecting	Active human	1.0E-1	No skin contact with liquid propane	Supervision	

Consequence	Condition	Barriers	Residual /yr	Risk rank
Prolonged jet fire at the bay – flame impingement, no BLEVE	0.09	Gas detection and ESD isolation (GLD-1/2/3, UCP-1, ESD-1, ROV-1 / ROV-11)	2.9E-5	Low
BLEVE of the tanker or a bullet – fireball and fragments	0.1	Gas detection and ESD isolation (GLD-1/2/3, UCP-1, ESD-1, ROV-1 / ROV-11) Sprinkler / deluge cooling of the bullets and tanker prevents a BLEVE	3.3E-6	Medium
Large flash fire from a prolonged release	0.63	Gas detection and ESD isolation (GLD-1/2/3, UCP-1, ESD-1, ROV-1 / ROV-11) Ignition source control – Ex equipment, hot-work permits, vehicle control	2.1E-5	Low
Vapour cloud explosion – blast damage, multiple fatalities	0.27	Gas detection and ESD isolation (GLD-1/2/3, UCP-1, ESD-1, ROV-1 / ROV-11) Ignition source control – Ex equipment, hot-work permits, vehicle control	8.8E-6	Medium
Cold burns to the operator from liquid propane	0.05	Cryogenic gloves, face shield and training for connecting / disconnecting	4.2E-5	Low

The overfill threat (T1) and hose failure (T2) dominate the top event; overfill is the threat the source study understated.

9.2 BT-PR-02 – Ignition of a propane–air mixture inside the dilution system

Threat T1 = flammable mixture (fault tree FT-PR-02 demand gate G-006) with the mixture-protection barrier = FT-PR-02 gate G-002, and a conditional probability of ignition (flashback at a burner) of 0.5 – its contribution is the FT-PR-02 top event x 0.5. HAZOP N03; FMECA S03. Illustrative data.



BT-PR-02 as drawn by Bow Tie Analysis.

Hazard: Propane–air mixture (55 % propane) at 0.8 barg in mixer MX-01, surge tank ST-01 and the header to the burners. Top event: Ignition of a propane–air mixture inside the mixer, surge tank or header – frequency 7.6E-3 /yr.

Threat	Frequency /yr	Condition	Barriers	Contribution /yr
Propane–air mixture enters the flammable range (propane lost, air continues)	7.0E-1	0.5	Mixture protection – PSLL-01 trip and calorimeter trip AT-01	6.1E-3
Start-up with air in the mixer, surge tank or header	2.0E-1	0.5	Start-up procedure OP-PR-020 – N2 purge, propane before air Mixture verified on AT-01 before the users are opened	1.0E-3
Flashback from a burner into the header	5.0E-1	0.1	Users' burner management – low fuel pressure and flame-failure trips In-line flame arrester FA-01 on the propane–air header	5.0E-4

Barrier	Type	PFD	Performance standard	Verification	Critical
Mixture protection – PSLL-01 trip and calorimeter trip AT-01	Active hardware	1.8E-2	Air stopped before the mixture reaches 15 % propane	Annual trip tests	Yes

Barrier	Type	PFD	Performance standard	Verification	Critical
Start-up procedure OP-PR-020 – N2 purge, propane before air	Active human	1.0E-1	No air in the system at start-up	Observation audits	
Mixture verified on AT-01 before the users are opened	Active human	1.0E-1	Users opened only with mixture in specification	Log check	
In-line flame arrester FA-01 on the propane–air header	Passive hardware	1.0E-1	Flame stopped at FA-01	Six-monthly inspection (R-015)	Yes
Explosion vent panel EP-01 on surge tank ST-01	Passive hardware	1.0E-2	Panel opens before ST-01 ruptures	Annual inspection	Yes
Users' burner management – low fuel pressure and flame-failure trips	Active hardware	1.0E-1	Burners trip before flashback	Annual BMS test	
No personnel at the mixing station during start-up and mixture changes	Active human	1.0E-1	Area clear during start-up	Supervision	

Consequence	Condition	Barriers	Residual /yr	Risk rank
Surge tank / header ruptures – explosion near the furnace building	1	Explosion vent panel EP-01 on surge tank ST-01	7.6E-5	Medium
Deflagration vented by EP-01 – damage to the mixing station, outage	1	No personnel at the mixing station during start-up and mixture changes	7.6E-4	Medium

The internal-explosion frequency 7.6E-5 /yr is just below the 1E-4 /yr target – with little margin, so R-013 and R-014 are High priority.

10 How the tools link – cross-reference

The cross-link tests (section 11) prove each of these links on the files themselves.

From	To	What is shared
HAZID HZD-02, HZD-12	HAZOP N01-06, N03-01	Hazards sent to HAZOP nodes
HAZOP N01-06	FT-PR-01	Overfill scenario; likelihood after safeguards from the FT top event
HAZOP N03-01	FT-PR-02	Flammable-mixture scenario; likelihood from the FT top event
FT-PR-01 G-002	BT-PR-01 barrier OVERFILL	Overfill protection PFDavg (live link)
FT-PR-01 G-006	BT-PR-01 threat T1	Overfill demand frequency
FT-PR-03 G-001	ETA-PR-01 H2 and BT-PR-01 barrier ESD	ESD PFDavg (live links)
BT-PR-01 top event	ETA-PR-01 initiating event	Release frequency
ETA-PR-01 end states	BT-PR-01 consequences JET, BLEVE, FF, VCE	Same frequencies
FT-PR-02 G-002 / G-006	BT-PR-02 barrier MIXPROT / threat T1	Mixture protection and demand
FMECA S01–S03	HAZOP N01–N03, FT events	Same tags and failure modes

10.1 Key results

Value	Result
Bullet overfill frequency /yr (FT-PR-01)	1.9E-3
Overfill protection PFDavg	3.9E-3
Overfill demand /yr	5.0E-1
Flammable mixture /yr (FT-PR-02)	1.2E-2
Mixture protection PFDavg	1.8E-2
Mixture demand /yr	7.0E-1
Gas detection & ESD PFDavg (FT-PR-03)	3.9E-2
Gas detection & ESD RRF	2.5E1
Loss of containment /yr (BT-PR-01)	8.3E-3
BT1_JET	2.9E-5
BT1_BLEVE	3.3E-6
BT1_FF	2.1E-5
BT1_VCE	8.8E-6
BT1_COLD	4.2E-5
Ignition in the dilution system /yr (BT-PR-02)	7.6E-3
Internal explosion /yr	7.6E-5
BT2_DEFL	7.6E-4
Catastrophic (VCE / BLEVE) /yr (ETA-PR-01)	1.2E-5
Major /yr	5.0E-5
Serious /yr	8.0E-4
Moderate /yr	7.2E-4

11 Verification of the example (cross-link tests)

Every study file was re-opened in its toolkit app and recalculated by the app's own engine; the workbooks were recalculated in LibreOffice. The automated test (test_example.py) ran 433 checks: 433 passed, 0 failed.

Check group	Passed	Failed
A. Apps	30	0
B. Numbers	64	0
C. References	117	0
D. Tags	37	0
E. Workbooks	65	0
G. HAZID	74	0
F. Report	46	0

12 Recommendations register

No.	Recommendation	Responsible	Priority	HAZOP refs
R-001	Provide copper / aluminium / G.I. jumper strips for electrical continuity at every flange of the unloading line, check the resistance of all earthing strips and pits and keep a record; add an earth bonding interlock (EBI-1) so the compressors cannot start without a verified tanker earth (source recommendation no. 1, completed).	Electrical engineer	High	N01-03

No.	Recommendation	Responsible	Priority	HAZOP refs
R-002	Provide a diesel generator for back-up power to the propane storage system so that a power failure during unloading or supply leaves the system in a controlled state (source recommendation no. 2). Confirm that every ROV fails closed and that UCP-1 and the gas detection are on UPS-1.	Electrical engineer	Medium	N01-12, N02-10, N03-09
R-003	Add the bullet relief valves PSV-11/21/31 and PRV-01 to the statutory inspection schedule with a 2-yearly bench-test interval (source remark, made a recommendation).	Mechanical engineer	High	N01-02, N01-04
R-004	Make the overfill trip independent of the level gauge used for control: fit an independent high-high level switch on each bullet acting on ROV-11/21/31, and proof-test the trip every 6 months. Fault tree FT-PR-01 gives an overfill frequency of 1.9E-3 /yr with the protection PFDavg 3.9E-3.	Instrument engineer	High	N01-06
R-005	Add a written ullage calculation to the unloading checklist (volume in the bullet + delivery ≤ 85 %), signed before the compressor is started.	Utilities superintendent	High	N01-06, N01-11, N02-09
R-006	Fit an emergency release coupling ERC-1 and a tanker brake interlock at the unloading bay; drive-away during unloading is not covered by the source safeguards.	Mechanical engineer	High	N01-10
R-007	Confirm that the bullets, the liquid lines and the unloading arm are rated for −45 °C (auto-refrigeration of propane on rapid depressurisation); the source worksheet recorded 'Lower temperature – no issue'.	Process engineer	High	N01-08
R-008	Verify the gas detection and ESD function against the required risk reduction: fault tree FT-PR-03 gives PFDavg 3.9E-2; relocate GLD-1/2/3 at low level (propane vapour is heavier than air) and add a detector at the compressor house.	Instrument engineer	High	N01-09, N02-08, N03-08
R-009	Check the bullet sprinkler / deluge coverage and density against the fire-case relief study and add automatic start on fire detection at the unloading bay (BLEVE prevention); test annually.	Fire officer	High	N01-07
R-010	Fit a low-suction-pressure trip and seal-pot alarm on P-01/P-02; replace single seals with double mechanical seals.	Mechanical engineer	Medium	N02-02, N02-08
R-011	Provide a second, independent liquid carry-over protection on each vaporiser (high-level trip LSH-01 in addition to TSL-01) and test both every 6 months.	Instrument engineer	High	N02-04, N02-05
R-012	Confirm the set-point staggering of PCV-01 (1.5 barg), SSV-01 (2.5 barg) and PSV-03 (3.0 barg) against the vapour header design pressure (3.5 barg).	Process engineer	Medium	N02-03
R-013	Upgrade the propane–air mixture protection: make the calorimeter AT-01 trip independent of FFIC-01 and add a second low propane pressure switch (1oo2). Fault tree FT-PR-02 gives a flammable-mixture frequency of 1.2E-2 /yr (protection PFDavg 1.8E-2); bow tie BT-PR-02 internal explosion 7.6E-5 /yr.	Instrument engineer	High	N03-01, N03-02, N03-05
R-014	Rewrite the mixing-station start-up procedure OP-PR-020: N2 purge, propane established before air, AT-01 reading verified before the users are opened; add a start-permissive interlock.	Utilities superintendent	High	N03-06, N03-09
R-015	Inspect flame arrester FA-01 every 6 months (fouling) and confirm it is rated for the propane–air mixture and pipe length (in-line deflagration arrester).	Mechanical engineer	Medium	N03-07
R-016	Introduce a vehicle-movement plan for the unloading bay (no other traffic during unloading, crash barriers around the bullets and the arm).	Area owner	Medium	N01-01
R-017	Train LPG operators on the response to a release (ESD, evacuation upwind, no attempt to stop a burning leak, cooling of exposed vessels) with a drill twice a year; event tree ETA-PR-01 gives 1.2E-5 /yr for a vapour cloud explosion or BLEVE.	HSE / process safety	High	N01-07

13 Conclusions

- The source worksheet's weakest entries were the ones with the largest hazards: overfill, low temperature and the fire case. Completing them changed the risk picture of node 301.
- Bullet overfill (1.9E-3 /yr) is the main threat to containment; an independent high-high level trip (R-004) and a written ullage check (R-005) are the priority actions.
- In the dilution system, a flammable propane–air mixture (1.2E-2 /yr) gives an internal-explosion frequency of 7.6E-5 /yr – close to the 1E-4 /yr target; R-013 and R-014 restore the margin.
- The release outcomes meet their targets (VCE / BLEVE 1.2E-5 /yr) as long as the ESD (PFDavg 3.9E-2) and the sprinkler cooling perform as assumed – both depend on R-008 and R-009.

14 Limitations

- All design data and failure data are illustrative. Library values marked 'typical' must be verified against the edition used; site and vendor data take precedence.
- Consequence severities are judgement; no dispersion, fire or explosion modelling was done.
- Nodes 302 and 303 were developed for this example and are not part of the source study.